



Diary System

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Mechanic overview

The diary is a diegetic catalogue that automatically records items, thoughts, key people and places of interest through gameplay



Design Goals

Provide a clear method for tracking discoveries

Deliver world information through gameplay interactions

Ensure consistent behavior across all collectable types

Create a scalable, data-driven architecture



Data Asset Architecture

Collectable Data

Stores shared fields (ID, Name, Description, Icon)



Item Data

Thoughts Data

People Data

Places Data

Designer-friendly

consistent

Why?

Scalable



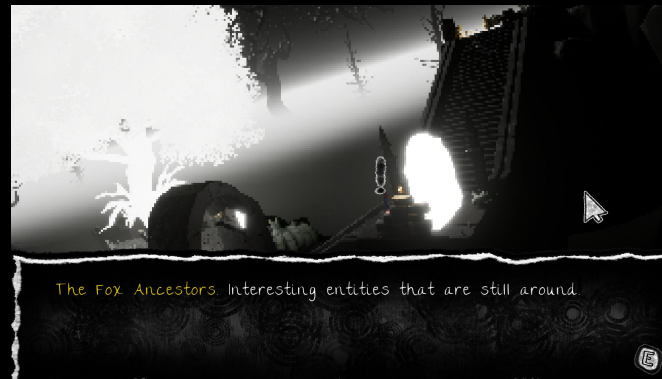
Collectable Base Class

Data Asset Reference

Each collectable type is defined as a Data Asset derived from `UCollectableData`

Two acquisition methods

Earned through interactable pickups or dialogue keyword triggers



Diary Menu UI Flow



Work in progress ui - Layout shown for flow demonstration

System Flow

Player Interaction

Player picks up an item or triggers a dialogue keyword

Source system

The interactable Item Actor or Dialogue System sends the relevant CollectableID or keyword to the Progression Subsystem

Progression Subsystem

Centralized logic that validates the entry, saves it, rebuilds runtime lists, and broadcasts unlock events

UI update

The Diary menu pulls the updated data and displays the new entry



What I Learned

Centralising progression logic

Moving unlock logic into a subsystem made the feature easier to maintain and extend

Designing UI around data

The diary updates automatically based on collected IDs, not hardcoded references

unifying acquisition paths

Item pickups and dialogue triggers now feed into the same system instead of separate code paths

Separating data from behaviour

Keeping Collectable Data Assets pure data improved clarity and reduced coupling

